

THE HIDDEN STORAGE KILLERS

Sometimes you do not need more storage. You need less nonsense like screenshots, duplicates and junk you forgot to delete.

WhatsApp's official storage tools exist for a reason. The service lets you review large files and frequently forwarded items precisely because chats become digital landfills if nobody intervenes. Likewise, duplicate photos, burst shots, old downloads, and saved social-media clips often occupy significant space without providing any real value. Before you jump to a larger plan, clean the easy junk first.

This matters because the cheapest storage upgrade is still the delete key.

use, and regular video clips can make 50GB feel like a waiting room rather than a solution. Apple also allows iCloud+ Family Sharing with up to five others, and Google One supports sharing with up to five additional people, which makes these plans more sensible for households than for solo users.

Step-by-step: how families should estimate storage

1. Count how many active phones are backing up to the same ecosystem.
2. Identify whether the plan is shared or per-person.
3. Check whether videos are a frequent habit, not just photos.



4. Add a buffer for at least one year of growth.
5. Prefer a slightly larger plan over a too-tight one if multiple people depend on it.

The family rule is simple: shared memories create shared storage pressure.

The student: 100GB is often the sweet spot

Students usually imagine they need very little storage because “it’s just documents.” That can be true for a first-year note-taker, but it becomes less true once presentations, PDFs, project videos, scanned certificates, internship materials, recorded classes, design files and phone media start colliding in one account.

A student often benefits from 100GB because it is the first tier that feels like room rather than rationing. It is enough for documents, cloud-synced notes, personal photos, and a modest safety margin. It is especially useful in Google’s ecosystem because that same storage can absorb Gmail, Drive and Photos together. On the Microsoft side, 100GB in Microsoft 365 Basic can also make sense if the workflow is document-heavy and Windows-led.

Students should resist one common mistake: using free tiers right until they hit the limit in exam week. That is how backups quietly fail when you least want them to.



The hybrid worker or freelancer: 200GB to 1TB

This is the user who has:

- invoices
- contracts
- scanned KYC documents
- work presentations
- video-call recordings
- client assets
- exported photos or design materials
- years of email and attachments